

You can change the setting at the installation step itself, or after the installation is complete.

The setting for network adapters is most likely located under the system menu. It is difficult to pin-point the menu under which the network setting is located because this not only varies from one distribution to another, it also changes with desktop environments (KDE or GNOME). Any method used to configure the network card will edit a set of files that is common to all Linux systems. So if you are brave enough to use root privileges and edit system files, go ahead. For beginners, we shall take one example of a GNOME desktop and one for a KDE desktop. This way, you'll get a picture of how to go about looking for this setting. We shall then take a look at the files that are eventually edited. Knowing this will help you set up a network adapter on any machine. The Linux kernel supports almost all network cards, and so it's unlikely that you will have any installation troubles.

However, before you proceed with the configuration of your network card, you must disable it if it is already running. Open a terminal window and use the command "ifconfig" to know if your Ethernet card is running. It will also tell you if it is eth0, eth1, etc. Let's assume it is eth0; then, shut down the network services, use the command "ifconfig eth0 down" or "ifdown eth0". You can now proceed with the configuration of the network card.



Use the Network Configuration tool to enter the IP address and other network information